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INTRODUCTION

The present collection of articles offers the first large-scale study of the Latin reception of Aristotle's *De sensu et sensato*. Its fifteen contributions range from the first commentaries on Aristotle's tract in the mid-thirteenth century to the waning of Scholastic Aristotelianism by the mid-seventeenth century and the emergence of new philosophies in the vernacular.

Aristotle's tract "on sense and the sensible" is the first of the so-called *Parva naturalia*: a collection of essays on various psycho-physiological subjects – such as memory, dreaming and ageing – along the lines of Aristotle's grand treatise on the soul¹. Aristotle's *De anima* exerted an enormous influence on medieval, renaissance and early modern thinkers: its reception has often been investigated in the literature, and it is still at the centre of many lively debates. In contrast, only in recent years have scholars begun to enquire into the legacy

1. The treatises included in the *Parva naturalia* are, in the order of the Bekker edition: *De sensu et sensato*, *De memoria et reminiscencia*, *De somno et vigilia*, *De insomniis*, *De divinatione per somnum*, *De longitudine et brevitate vitae*, *De iuventute et senectute*, *De vita et morte* and *De respiratione*. However, the Medieval Latin manuscript tradition of the *Parva naturalia* is far more complicated. For instance, in the Latin Middle Ages *De somno et vigilia*, *De insomniis* and *De divinatione per somnum* were usually grouped together in a single treatise – under the title *De somno et vigilia* – comprising two books: *De somno et vigilia* proper and, to follow, *De insomniis* and *De divinatione per somnum* together. Moreover, other treatises were sometimes added to the collection, the most frequent case in point being the *De motu animalium* (together with the Pseudo-Aristotelian *De mundo*). Finally, especially in the early Latin reception of the *Parva naturalia*, some of the treatises listed above were sometimes excluded from the collection, and their overall order was a matter of contention: suffice it to say that *De memoria* was initially considered to be the last chapter of the *De anima*, or to come immediately after it (before *De sensu et sensato*). Some of these difficulties are addressed in the articles that follow; see in particular those by Galle and Masolini.

of the *Parva naturalia* in the Greek, Arabic and Latin Middle Ages². These studies are revealing an extremely rich, sophisticated and varied picture and have clarified the importance and, indeed, the sore need for further research. In particular, thus far, no monography or collection of essays has considered the medieval, renaissance, or early modern reception of Aristotle's *De sensu et sensato* itself, let alone its Latin reception specifically. The present collection aims to fill this gap in the literature, with the intention of fostering further research on this most fascinating subject.

The absence of any previous systematic study of the Latin tradition of Aristotle's *De sensu* is partly due to an inveterate prejudice that can already be traced back to the sixteenth century³. Indeed, Manuel de Góis – the Jesuit in charge of the highly-influential *Cursus Conimbricensis* – dismissed Aristotle's tract on the sense as a mere “appendix” to *De anima* and, accordingly, did not comment on it⁴. More recent interpreters are usually warier. However, a tacit lore still retains that the Latin commentaries on *De sensu* do not have much of value to add to the *De anima* commentaries.

2. See, in particular, *Parva naturalia. Saperi medievali, natura e vita. Atti dell'11° convegno della Società italiana per lo studio del pensiero medievale (Macerata, 7-9 dicembre 2001)*, ed. C. Crisciani, R. Lambertini, R. Martorelli Vico, Pisa – Roma 2004; *Les Parva naturalia d'Aristote, Fortune antique et médiévale*, ed. P.-M. Morel, C. Grellard, Paris 2010; *The Parva naturalia in Greek, Arabic and Latin Aristotelianism. Supplementing the Science of the Soul*, ed. B. Bydén, F. Radovic, Cham 2018.

3. Some Medieval Latin *De sensu* commentaries have already been the focus of important publications. As for John of Jandun's *Quaestiones* see, for instance, J.-B. Brenet, «Le feu agit-il en tant que feu? Causalité et synonymie dans les *Quaestiones* sur le *De sensu et sensato* de Jean de Jandun», in *Les Parva naturalia d'Aristote*, ed. Morel, Grellard, 163–95; A. Robert, «John of Jandun on *Minima Sensibilia*», *Documenti e studi sulla tradizione filosofica medievale*, XXV (2014), 365–402; Id., «John of Jandun on Sense Perception and Instantaneous Change», in *Philosophical Problems in Sense Perception: Testing the Limits of Aristotelianism*, ed. D. Bennett, J. Toivanen, Cham 2020, 193–212 (to be read together with S. Ebbesen, «Alexander of Aphrodisias, Brito and Jandun: Comments on Aurélien Robert's Paper», in *Philosophical Problems in Sense Perception*, ed. Bennett, Toivanen, 213–21).

4. Manuel de Góis, *Commentarii Collegii Conimbricensis Societatis Iesu In libros Aristotelis, qui Parva Naturalia appellantur*, Olisipone 1593, f. 2: “Quod tamen ad libros *De sensu et sensibilibus* attinet, in quibus Aristoteles de sensuum organis eorumque obiectis potissimum disserit, statuimus nihil hoc loco in eos commentari, quod tota ea disputatio abunde tractata atque illustrata a nobis sit in libris *De anima*, quos una cum libris *De ortu et interitu* propediem favente Deo in lucem edemus” (modified punctuation).

The present collection of essays proves at a glance that this is not quite the case. One of our main aims in putting together these articles was to provide an overview or, even better, a representative selection of the diversity and originality of topics treated by the Latin *De sensu* commentators, starting shortly after the first translation of Aristotle's tract (*ante* 1232) and continuing well into the early modern age⁵.

Indeed, the first reason that makes the present study of the Latin reception of *De sensu et sensato* especially necessary is its undisputed *fortuna* throughout four centuries and beyond. The sheer figures are telling.

For the period between the thirteenth and the fifteenth century, the available catalogues of Medieval Latin Aristotelian commentaries list at least sixty surviving commentaries on *De sensu*, preserved in more than one-hundred manuscript witnesses – and this is a conservative estimate⁶. In addition, according to the list included in the

5. On the so-called *translatio vetus*, see at least G. Galle, «The Dating and Earliest Reception of the *Translatio vetus* of Aristotle's *De sensu*», *Medioevo*, XXXIII (2008), 7–96; G. Galle, «The Anonymous Translator of the *Translatio Vetus* of *De sensu*», *Bulletin de philosophie médiévale*, 50 (2008), 105–50; D. Bloch, «Nicholaus Graecus and the *Translatio Vetus* of Aristotle's *De sensu*», *Bulletin de philosophie médiévale*, 50 (2008), 83–103. Bloch and Galle disagree on the attribution of the translation: Bloch takes on trust the attribution (to be found in one of the manuscript witnesses) to 'Nicholaus Reginus', whom he identifies with the 'Nicholaus Siculus' who later likely authored a Latin translation of the Pseudo-Aristotelian *De mundo*, and who is also likely to be the 'Nicholaus Graecus' member of Grosseteste's *entourage*. Galle speaks of an anonymous translator. However, they agree in dating the translation to the first decades of the thirteenth century (not to the second half of the twelfth century, as previously believed). Bloch favours the period 1215–1225; Galle limits herself to indicate 1232 as the *terminus ante quem* – the latest possible date of composition of an anonymous treatise *De potentiis animae et obiectis*, which explicitly quotes the *translatio vetus*. It must be noted that some excerpts of the *De sensu* had already been quoted in Latin in David of Dinant's *Quaternuli*, which were condemned to be burnt in 1210.

6. This estimate is based on a new inventory of Medieval Latin *De sensu* commentaries (dating between the thirteenth and the fifteenth century) in preparation as part of Roberto Zambiasi's PhD dissertation *The Medieval Latin Debate on the Problem of Minima sensibilia* (ca. 1250–ca. 1350). Of the only two available catalogues specifically listing Medieval Latin *De sensu* commentaries, the former only includes question commentaries dating between ca. 1260 and ca. 1320; cf. S. Ebbesen, C. Thomsen Thörnqvist, V. Decaix, «Questions on *De sensu et sensato*, *De memoria* and *De somno et vigilia*. A Catalogue», *Bulletin de philosophie médiévale*, 57 (2015), 59–115. The only other catalogue of Medieval Latin *De sensu* commentaries, by J. De Raedemaeker, sets no such strict chronological boundaries and is therefore much richer, but does not still aim

relevant volumes of the *Codices* of the *Aristoteles Latinus*, there could be up to two hundred manuscript witnesses of Latin translations of *De sensu* bearing interlinear and/or marginal glosses to the text⁷. These are sometimes limited to a few words, but in other cases grow into full-fledged commentaries. To these, one should furthermore add a number of compendia, paraphrases, and similar pieces of writing all devoted to Aristotle's *De sensu*. It is fair to say that the amount of commentaries on it produced during the Latin Middle Ages is imposing and is crying out for a large-scale study.

This impressive legacy did not stop in the Middle Ages. Suffice it to consider that the first printed edition of Aristotle's *De sensu* was published by none other than Aldo Manuzio, as early as in 1497⁸. In spite of Manuel de Góis, Aristotle's tract continued to be glossed and discussed until the seventeenth century and beyond. Charles Lohr provided an important inventory of these commentaries, among which it is important to at least mention Goclenius' "castigated version" of 1596⁹.

Most medieval commentaries, and more than a few renaissance and early modern ones, are only extant in manuscript form, often-times in a single, incomplete manuscript witness, thereby making

at exhaustiveness: as its title indicates, it is only a preliminary inventory; J. De Raedemaeker, «Une ébauche de catalogue des commentaires sur les *Parva naturalia* parus aux XIII^e, XIV^e et XV^e siècles», *Bulletin de philosophie medievale*, 7 (1965), 95–108. Moreover, this inventory frequently lists commentaries on *Parva naturalia* without indicating which specific treatises are commented upon.

7. Cf. *Aristoteles Latinus. Codices: Pars Prior*, codices descripsit G. Lacombe, in *societatem operis adsumptis* A. Birkenmajer, M. Dulong, Aet. Franceschini, Rome 1939; *Aristoteles Latinus. Codices: Pars Posterior et Supplementa*, codices descripsit G. Lacombe, in *societatem operis adsumptis* A. Birkenmajer, M. Dulong, Aet. Franceschini, supplementis indicibusque instruxit L. Minio-Paluello, Cambridge 1955; *Aristoteles Latinus. Codices: Supplementa altera*, ed. L. Minio-Paluello, Bruges 1961. Cf. also the draft version of *Aristoteles Latinus. Codices: Supplementa tertia*, under the editorial supervision of Pieter Beullens, available online at <https://zenodo.org/record/7111413#.Y3qcEC1aa8U>, which lists the new findings emerged since the publication of the *Supplementa altera* in 1961.

8. On the quality and the textual foundation of this edition, see D. Bloch, «The Aldine Edition of Aristotle's *De sensu*», *Cahiers de l'Institut du Moyen-Âge Grec et Latin*, 77 (2006), 147–55.

9. The full title reads *Libelli Aristotelis De sensu et sensilibus, castigata versio & analysis logica, cum quaestionibus & disputationibus inde desumptis*. Cf. C. H. Lohr, *Latin Aristotle Commentaries. Vol. II: Renaissance Authors*, Firenze 1988.

their study all the more complex. True, some Medieval Latin *De sensu* commentaries are available in reliable critical editions¹⁰, and some in (not so reliable) early modern prints¹¹. Moreover, as of recently, there have been valuable editorial initiatives – such as those carried out by, among others, Sten Ebbesen and Juhana Toivanen – targeting significant samples of unedited Latin *De sensu* commentaries, mainly from the second half of the thirteenth and the first half of the fourteenth century¹². Finally, there are ongoing projects to edit important *De sensu* commentaries such as Walter Burley's *Expositio* (by Monika Mansfeld within the framework of a wider editorial project under the aegis of Marek Gensler, at the University of Łódź), one redaction of Buridan's *Quaestiones* and of Marsilius of Inghen's *Quaestiones* (by Maciej Stanek, at the University of Silesia in Katowice) and Peter of Rivo's *Lectura* (by Serena Masolini, at

10. Cf. J. Agrimi, *Le Quaestiones de sensu attribuite a Oresme e Alberto di Sassonia*, Firenze 1983; Albertus Magnus, *Alberti Magni Ordinis Fratrum Praedicatorum De nutrimento et nutritio. De sensu et sensato cuius secundus liber est De memoria et reminiscencia* (*Alberti Magni Opera Omnia, Editio Coloniensis, Tomus VII Pars II.A*), ed. S. Donati, Münster 2017; Thomas de Aquino, *Sancti Thomae de Aquino Sentencia libri De sensu et sensato cuius secundus tractatus est De memoria et reminiscencia* (*Sancti Thomae de Aquino Opera Omnia, Editio Leonina, Tomus XLV.2*), ed. R.-A. Gauthier, Roma-Paris 1986; Rogerus Baco, *Liber de sensu et sensato. Summa de sophismatibus et distinctionibus* (*Opera Hactenus Inedita Rogeri Baconi Fasc. XIV*), ed. R. Steele, Oxford 1937, and K. White, *Two Studies Related to St. Thomas's Commentary on Aristotle's De sensu et sensato together with an Edition of Peter of Auvergne's Quaestiones super Parva naturalia* (PhD dissertation), 2 volumes, Ottawa 1986.

11. Cf., for instance, Johannes de Janduno, *Quaestiones super De sensu et sensato* (editio princeps: *Quaestiones super Parvis naturalibus*, Venetiis 1505), and Johannes Buridanus, *Quaestiones super De sensu et sensato* (editio princeps: *Quaestiones et decisiones physicales insignium virorum: Alberti de Saxonia in Octo libros physicorum. Tres libros de coelo et mundo. Duos lib. de generatione et corruptione. Thimonis in quatuor libros Meteororum. Buridani in Aristotelis. Tres lib. De anima. Lib. de sensu et sensato. Librum de memoria et reminiscencia. Librum de somno et vigilia. Lib. de longitudine et brevitate vitae. Lib. de iuventute et senectute*, ed. G. Lockert, Parisiis 1516).

12. Cf. S. Ebbesen, «Does Language Acquisition Depend on Hearing a Language? A Text Corpus», *Cahiers de l'Institut du Moyen-Âge Grec et Latin*, 86 (2017), 138–215; Id., «Anonymus Vaticanus 3061 and Anonymus Vaticanus 2170 on Aristotle's *Parva Naturalia*. An Edition of Selected Questions», *Cahiers de l'Institut du Moyen-Âge Grec et Latin*, 86 (2017), 216–312, and J. Toivanen, «Medieval Commentators on Simultaneous Perception: An Edition of Commentaries on Aristotle's *De sensu et sensato* 7», *Cahiers de l'Institut du Moyen-Âge grec et latin*, 90 (2021), 112–225.

KU Leuven)¹³. It is clear, however, that most of the work remains to be done.

The present collection of essays does not aim to present new critical editions of Latin *De sensu* commentaries, nor is it intended to offer a thorough reconstruction of the manuscript tradition of any of those. Nevertheless, a number of articles also prove relevant in this regard, in view of future critical editions. In particular, Griet Galle's contribution provides updates on the manuscript tradition of the three *De sensu* commentaries attributed to Adam of Bockenfield and his circle and assesses anew the question of their attribution. In an appendix to her essay, Galle includes an edition of a selection of passages from these mid-thirteenth-century commentaries, which reflect on the order of the *Parva naturalia*.

The issue of ordering also features prominently in the essay by Serena Masolini, which provides a new study of the anonymous *De sensu* commentaries (an *expositio* and *copulata* of *quaestiones non disputatae*) found in ms. Aberdeen, University Library, 110, showing their link with the only other extant fifteenth-century *De sensu* commentary produced at the newly established Faculty of Arts of Leuven university – the *Lectura* by Peter of Rivo, of which the *expositio* of the Aberdeen manuscript is shown by Masolini to be a so-far-unknown third manuscript witness. These are notable findings that call for reconsidering a comparatively lesser-known strand and tradition of Latin Aristotelianism.

This imposing body of commentaries permits us to reconsider Latin Aristotelianism from a fresh, unique perspective. Indeed, the *De*

13. A preliminary version of Serena Masolini's edition of Peter of Rivo's *Lectura super librum De sensu et sensato* is available online at <https://hiw.kuleuven.be/dwmc/research/peterderivo>. Maciej Stanek has produced a preliminary version of a critical edition of Buridan's commentary as part of his PhD dissertation (*Jana Burydana. Quaestiones super Parva Naturalia Aristotelis. Edycja krytyczna i analiza historyczno-filozoficzna*, Katowice 2015) and has recently published a critical edition of the *Puncta* developed in Kraków from Nicholas of Brega's *De sensu* commentary and of the *Problemata* that (in some manuscript witnesses) form an appendix to one of Buridan's *De sensu* commentaries; see M. Stanek, «Puncta ex commentario Nicolai Tempelfeld de Brzeg in Parva naturalia: Editio critica», *Przegląd Tomistyczny*, XXIV (2018), 289–319; Id., «Problemata Parvorum naturalium: An Anonymous Supplement to John Buridan's Commentary on the *Parva naturalia*», *Przegląd Tomistyczny*, XXVII (2021), 61–105.

sensu commentaries prove especially important and original even when they consider topics also found in Aristotle's *De anima* and relevant commentaries. This should not come as a surprise. Both *De anima* and *De sensu* discuss the perceptual process for each of the five external senses (apart from hearing, which is not singled out for consideration in the latter work) as well as the nature of their specific objects of perception – what Aristotle calls their “proper sensibles”, such as colours for sight and flavours for taste. However, the two treatises focus on different aspects, in keeping with their distinct approaches and aims. To simplify matters drastically, *De anima* tends to focus on the nature of the perceivers' sensory powers and on the epistemology of perception, whereas *De sensu* (especially in chapters 3–5, after the “general introduction” to the *Parva naturalia* and an examination of the sense organs, respectively contained in chapter 1 and 2) presents Aristotle's most thorough discussion of the nature of proper sensibles and of their media.

These differences in scope are reflected in the commentary tradition. For instance, in her article, Yael Kedar shows that Roger Bacon's theory of colours cannot be adequately reconstructed without taking into account his *Liber de sensu*. In particular, this work permits us to correct recent interpretations and proves that Bacon was committed to an extreme realism concerning colours, which he conceived as products of elemental mixtures that are fully actual even in the absence of light. Albert the Great (whose role in the early Latin reception of the *De sensu* can hardly be overestimated¹⁴) provides one more notable example. Indeed, Silvia Donati shows that only Albert's paraphrase of *De sensu* accounts for his sophisticated theory of physical light as a quality of the diaphanous, propagating instantaneously and acting as an intermediary between the heavens and the sublunary world, against rival accounts of light as a spiritual body, a spiritual substance or a substantial form. The *De sensu* commentaries do not shed light only on vision. Thus, in his piece, Roberto Zambiasi shows that some of the most original the-

14. Cf. S. Donati, «The Critical Edition of Albert the Great's Commentaries on *De sensu et sensato* and *De memoria et reminiscencia*: Its Significance for the Study of the 13th-Century Reception of Aristotle's *Parva Naturalia* and its Problems», in *The Letter before the Spirit: The Importance of Text Editions for the Study of the Reception of Aristotle*, ed. A. van Oppenraay, R. Fontaine, Leiden 2012, 345–99.

oretical proposals concerning the ontology of odours – also with important epistemological consequences as for smell's intermediate nature between contact and distance senses – are to be found in a selection of mid-fourteenth-century Parisian *De sensu* commentaries belonging to the Buridianian intellectual milieu.

Latin *De sensu* commentaries also offered novel and original insights about topics at the forefront of Aristotle's *De anima*, such as the nature of the different sensory powers and their corresponding sense organs¹⁵. Consider, for example, Aristotle's claim about the "earthly" nature of the sense of touch, which he discusses in both works. Chiara Beneduce's article shows that some fourteenth-century Buridianian *De sensu* commentaries provide especially refined reconstructions of the elemental composition of the sensory organs by also bringing into play innovative elements taken from the medical tradition.

The significance and originality of medieval, renaissance and early modern *De sensu* commentaries become all the more evident because they discuss topics that do not appear in *De anima*. This is, for example, the case with Aristotle's three aporias about the external senses and their proper sensibles (to which the final two chapters of the *De sensu*, chapters 6 and 7, are devoted). These aporias address, in order: the infinite divisibility of the sensible qualities based on the division of the matter to which they are united (*De sensu* 6, 445b3–446a20); the temporal structure of the perceptual process (*De sensu* 6, 446a20–447a11); and, last, the possibility of simultaneous perceptions by different senses (*De sensu* 7, 447a12–449a3). All three aporias have fundamental bearings on decisive aspects of Aristotle's overall theory of perception, so that their study proves especially enlightening well beyond the *De sensu* tradition proper. In her article, Véronique Decaix provides a sample of its potential by considering and comparing some medieval attempts (specifically by Albert the Great, Thomas Aquinas and John Buridan) to square away Aristotle's second aporia by reconsidering the ontological status of sensible qualities in the medium and their causal agency.

15. Cf., for example, P. B. Rossi, «Odeurs, saveurs (et couleurs): *esse materiale* ou *esse intentionale*? Réponses de quelques maîtres du XIII^e siècle», in *Parfums et odeurs au Moyen Âge. Science, usage, symboles*, ed. A. Paravicini Bagliani, Firenze 2015, 301–28.

Nevertheless, the inventiveness of Latin *De sensu* commentators made it so that they sometimes singled out for consideration some marginal remarks by Aristotle and turned them into a major topic of debate, well beyond Aristotle's apparent intentions. This is, for example, the case of Aristotle's annotation that, of those who are deprived from birth of either sight or hearing, the blind are wiser than the mute and deaf (*De sensu* 1, 437a16–17). Kevin White's article attests to the theoretical richness and the wider – also pedagogical – implications of Albert the Great's, Thomas Aquinas' and Peter of Auvergne's commentaries on this passage and demonstrates how this discussion allowed these thinkers to reflect more widely on the role of sight and hearing in acquiring and trading knowledge.

The ingenuity of medieval commentators could reach further still. Indeed, some of them took their cue from that very same passage to enquire into the innate or conventional nature of human languages and the causes of their diversity. By looking at five Parisian *De sensu* commentaries dating in or around the fourteenth century, Aurélien Robert effectively shows how these *magistri artium* strove to develop philosophical and “naturalistic” explanations of the diversity of languages to provide a valid alternative to the Biblical narrative of the Tower of Babel. Their explanations ranged from a more or less strict “environmental determinism” based on the influence of the climate and the celestial bodies to accounts that centred on the role of people's free will.

Renaissance commentators, all their philological scruples notwithstanding – if not precisely on their account – were no strangers to these highly selective reading practices. In his essay, Luca Burzelli provides an example thereof in relation to Aristotle's remark that “fire and earth... taken absolutely as such, have no natural power to affect, or be affected by, one another” (*De sensu et sensato* 4, 441b10–12) and of the fierce debate – heated, even – to which it gave rise among early sixteenth-century commentators of the calibre of Pietro Pomponazzi and Gasparo Contarini.

This brief overview should suffice to establish the intrinsic importance and independence of Latin *De sensu* commentaries from corresponding *De anima* commentaries. This is obviously not intended to deny the close ties and intimate connections between the two. As it happens, many articles of the present collection consider the interplay between *De anima* and *De sensu* – and relative

commentaries – as well as between *De sensu* and the *Parva naturalia* at large and with Aristotle's other works more generally. In particular, the tight exegetical interplay between the *De sensu* commentaries and those on Aristotle's other works also reflects the institutional system of the medieval (but also much later) Faculties of Arts, in which the lectures on *De sensu* were routinely followed by classes on the remaining *Parva naturalia* – especially on *De memoria et remniscentia* – but also on Aristotle's zoological works¹⁶.

An example of such strict connections is supplied by Gabriella Zuccolin's study of the relation between Albert the Great's hierarchy of the senses, as discussed in his *De sensu* commentary, and the hierarchy of living beings developed in his *De animalibus*. Albert intended to establish the superiority of human beings *qua* rational animals over all non-rational ones – including apes and pygmies, despite their considerable cognitive skills – based on his analysis of the senses and, particularly, of sight and hearing as the two “senses that allow learning” (*sensus disciplinales* or *disciplinabiles*).

One need not stop there. The commentary tradition on *De sensu* even moved beyond Aristotle's natural philosophy to call into question such an apparently distant field as ethics. In this respect, Carlos Steel's contribution shows how Aristotle's distinction between odours that are associated with nourishment and odours that are pleasant or unpleasant in themselves (*De sensu* 5, 443b17–444b7) led medieval thinkers – such as Albert the Great, Thomas Aquinas and Peter of Abano – to reflect on the nature of pleasure in general and

16. On the entangled relation between the *Parva naturalia* and Aristotle's zoological works, also due to their textual tradition – also on account of the distribution of the *peciae* in the official Paris *exemplar* – see at least P. de Lee-mans, «Secundum viam naturae et doctrinae. Lire le *De motu animalium* et les *Parva naturalia* d'Aristote au Moyen Âge», in *Les Parva naturalia d'Aristote*, ed. Morel, Grellard, 197–220. *Parva naturalia* (more precisely, the *De sensu et sensato*, the *De somno et vigilia*, the *De insomniis*, the *De divinatione per somnum*, the *De memoria et remniscentia*, and the *De longitudine et brevitae vitae* – at the time known as *De morte et vita*) were included in the syllabus of Aristotelians works to be taught at the Faculty of Arts in Paris in 1255. Albert the Great and Thomas Aquinas envisaged a yet deeper connection between *De sensu* and *De memoria*, and conceived of them as parts of a single treatise on the senses, devoted, in order, to the external and to the internal senses. *De facto*, however, they commented on the two as largely independent pieces of writing, and their *tandem* reading had no major consequences for their philosophical systems (as the relevant articles collected here attest).

on the specifically human form of sensual pleasure that is subordinate to no further end (*delectatio liberalis*).

It is almost astonishing to realise how much there still remains to do also as for all-known thinkers – especially those who made a name for themselves because of their reading of Aristotle’s psychology. Pomponazzi’s *Expositio libelli de sensu et sensato* (1524–1525) is exemplary in this respect and still in need of an edition. In his essay, Leonardo Graciotti investigates the *Expositio* in the context of the polemics spurred by Pomponazzi’s *De immortalitate animae* (1516) and examines the first of his *dubitationes* to determine Pomponazzi’s views on the interplay between philosophy and medicine¹⁷. Insightful remarks on the manuscript tradition of this work can also be found in Burzelli’s contribution.

The importance of the cultural and institutional settings in understanding how Aristotle’s *De sensu* was read, used, and perused in different contexts and times is further confirmed and nicely exemplified by Christophe Grellard’s essay, which considers a set of commentaries from mid-fifteenth-century to early sixteenth-century Paris and proves how even self-proclaimed followers of the *via Scoti* were in fact imbued with Buridan’s ideas.

This embedded history of reception leads to equally important historiographical and conceptual discoveries. For example, *De sensu* proves to make an unexpected appearance in polemics around the *Discours de la méthode* (1637): one of Descartes’ first opponents, Libert Froidmont, attacked Descartes’ theory of perception based on Aristotle’s argument against Democritus. Mattia Mantovani’s essay argues that Descartes himself worked out his perception theory by reflecting precisely on that passage (*De sensu* 4, 442a29–442b21) and by intentionally turning Aristotle’s arguments on their head.

Aristotle’s philosophy continued to be taught in European universities well into the eighteenth century, and his psychological writings – *De sensu* included – had a prominent place in this educational programme. The Aristotelian tradition waned slowly, at varying paces in different countries, with outbursts of resistance and sudden resurgences. However, the clash between Aristotle’s *De sensu et sensato* and

17. On the topic see also, more in general, R. Lo Presti, «Entre aristotélisme médical et médecine aristotélisante: le rapport entre médecine et philosophie dans les commentaires italiens du XVI^e siècle au *De sensu* d’Aristote», in *Médecins et philosophes: Une histoire*, ed. C. Crignon, D. Lefebvre, Paris 2019, 195–222.

Descartes' *Discours de la méthode* was the harbinger of a decisive, larger shift in the European cultural landscape. In the decades that followed, a Latin tradition that began more than four centuries earlier increasingly gave way to new philosophies speaking in the vernacular. Here, the story of our collection comes to its conclusion.

These few pages of introduction should have sufficed to show that the Latin tradition of Aristotle's *De sensu* is so rich and varied and has been so little studied up to this point that it calls for more than one collection of essays, however rich and varied it may be. The fifteen articles of this special issue should give a sense of the entangled – cultural and philological, institutional and pedagogical, exegetical and squarely philosophical – factors that shaped the Latin reception of Aristotle's *De sensu et sensato* and that make it such a fascinating and rewarding topic of research. We cannot but hope that the present collection will prompt more scholars to research this subject to better understand this decisive episode of medieval, renaissance and early modern philosophy alike.

This collection of essays originated from the international conference on *Aristotle's De sensu in the Latin Tradition 1150-1650*, held at the Department of Humanities of the University of Pavia on 13-14 September 2021, and at KU Leuven, De Wulf-Mansion Centre for Ancient, Medieval and Renaissance Philosophy, on 17-18 September 2021. Jointly organised by Carla Casagrande, Roberto Zambiasi and Gabriella Zuccolin (as for Pavia) and by Mattia Mantovani and Andrea Aldo Robiglio (as for Leuven), *Aristotle's De sensu in the Latin Tradition 1150-1650* was the first international conference entirely devoted to the Latin reception of the *De sensu et sensato* in the Middle Ages and the early modern period. We extend our heartfelt thanks to all the institutions and people who have made the Pavia-Leuven conference possible and to Agostino Paravicini Bagliani for hosting this collection of essays in *Micrologus. Nature, Sciences and Medieval Societies*¹⁸.

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